

Finding External Reviewers on LinkedIn

A Complete Guide for Academic Paper Review

Quick Overview

This guide provides a step-by-step approach to identifying, evaluating, and contacting potential external reviewers on LinkedIn for your JMLR paper 'LLMs as Interfaces to Symbolic Discovery.' The process takes approximately 2-3 hours to find 2 qualified reviewers who will provide valuable feedback on your hybrid symbolic-neural architecture.

Step 1: Define Your Ideal Reviewer Profile

For your paper, you need reviewers with expertise in at least 2-3 of these areas:

- Symbolic regression and genetic programming (PySR, gplearn, evolutionary algorithms)
- Large Language Models for scientific reasoning (GPT-4, Claude, prompt engineering)
- Scientific machine learning (physics-informed ML, equation discovery)
- Neural network extrapolation and generalization theory
- Statistical validation methodologies (non-parametric tests, effect sizes)

Target Reviewer Characteristics:

- Postdoctoral researchers or Assistant/Associate Professors (more likely to have time)
- Recent publications (2022-2025) in symbolic regression, LLMs, or SciML
- Active on LinkedIn with 500+ connections (indicates engagement)
- Based at research universities or AI labs (Anthropic, OpenAI, DeepMind, Google Research)
- NOT currently serving on JMLR editorial board (potential conflict of interest)

Step 2: Advanced LinkedIn Search Strategy

Search Query 1: Symbolic Regression Experts

Search box: "symbolic regression" OR "genetic programming" OR PySR

Then apply these filters:

- People (not Companies or Jobs)

- Locations: United States, United Kingdom, Canada, Germany, Netherlands (major ML hubs)
- Industry: Higher Education, Research, Computer Software
- Current companies: Universities, MIT, Stanford, Berkeley, CMU, ETH Zurich, Max Planck Institute

Search Query 2: LLM + Scientific ML Experts

Search box: "LLM" AND ("scientific discovery" OR "equation discovery" OR "symbolic learning")

Apply same location/industry filters as above.

Search Query 3: Neural Network Generalization Experts

Search box: "extrapolation" OR "out-of-distribution" OR "generalization" AND "neural networks"

Focus on researchers working on ML theory and generalization bounds.

Boolean Search Tips

LinkedIn supports boolean operators:

- AND - both terms must appear: "symbolic regression" AND "machine learning"
- OR - either term: "PySR" OR "gplearn" OR "genetic programming"
- NOT - exclude term: "machine learning" NOT "marketing"
- Quotes - exact phrase: "scientific machine learning"
- Parentheses - group terms: ("LLM" OR "GPT") AND "symbolic"

Step 3: Evaluate Candidate Reviewers

For each potential reviewer, check these criteria (aim for 6-8 points out of 10):

Criterion	Points
Recent publication (2023-2025) in symbolic regression or LLMs	2 points
PhD in relevant field (CS, Statistics, Physics, Engineering)	1 point
Active LinkedIn presence (posts, articles, comments in last 3 months)	1 point
Google Scholar profile with h-index > 10	2 points
Experience with statistical analysis (mentions p-values, effect sizes, etc.)	1 point
Previous peer review experience (mentions reviewing, program committees)	2 points

Open to collaboration (LinkedIn setting or mentioned in profile)	1 point
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Red Flags (Avoid These Candidates):

- No publications in the last 3 years (likely not active in research)
- Currently at JMLR or affiliated journals (conflict of interest)
- Profile indicates overwhelming workload (Chair of 5 committees, etc.)
- Industry role with no academic affiliation (may lack peer review culture)
- PhD student or very recent graduate (insufficient seniority for external review)

Step 4: Recommended Researcher Types

Based on your paper's focus, prioritize these researcher profiles:

Profile 1: Symbolic Regression Specialist

- Look for: Contributors to PySR, gplearn, or SymbolicRegression.jl
- Keywords: 'genetic programming', 'symbolic regression', 'equation discovery'
- Example institutions: MIT CSAIL, Max Planck Institute, ETH Zurich
- Why: Can evaluate your symbolic regression methodology and extrapolation claims
- Likely names to search: William La Cava, Brenden Petersen, researchers citing Koza 1994

Profile 2: LLM + Scientific Reasoning Expert

- Look for: Researchers working on LLMs for mathematics, theorem proving, or scientific tasks
- Keywords: 'large language models', 'mathematical reasoning', 'AI for science'
- Example institutions: Anthropic, OpenAI, Google DeepMind, Stanford, Princeton
- Why: Can evaluate your LLM limitations analysis and reproductive behavior claims
- Likely affiliations: AI safety labs, computational cognitive science groups

Profile 3: ML Theory / Generalization Expert

- Look for: Researchers publishing on generalization bounds, extrapolation, or OOD detection
- Keywords: 'generalization', 'out-of-distribution', 'neural network theory'
- Example institutions: UC Berkeley, CMU, MILA, Vector Institute
- Why: Can evaluate your $U=0$ statistical claim and interpolation vs extrapolation analysis
- Conferences: NeurIPS, ICML, ICLR (check recent program committees)

Step 5: Outreach Strategy

Connection Request Message

Keep it brief (300 characters max on LinkedIn):

Hi [Name], I'm Ruperto, an independent researcher working on hybrid LLM-symbolic approaches for scientific discovery. I came across your work on [specific paper/topic] and would value connecting to discuss potential collaboration. Best, Ruperto

Follow-up Message (After Connection Accepted)

Send this 24-48 hours after they accept:

Hi [Name], Thank you for connecting! I'm reaching out because I've completed a paper for JMLR titled 'LLMs as Interfaces to Symbolic Discovery' that demonstrates complete distribution separation (Mann-Whitney $U=0$) between symbolic and neural methods for extrapolation tasks. Given your expertise in [their specific area], I would greatly appreciate if you could serve as an external reviewer. The paper is 48 pages but the core results are in Sections 5-6. I'm particularly interested in feedback on: • The statistical methodology ($U=0$, effect sizes) • The extrapolation protocol design • The hybrid architecture validation framework I can provide the full paper + a 2-page summary. Expected time commitment: 3-5 hours over 2-3 weeks. Would you be available? Best regards, Ruperto Pedro Bonet Chaple
Independent Researcher, London ruperto.bonet@modelphysmat.com

Alternative: InMail Approach

If you have LinkedIn Premium, you can send InMail directly (more professional for cold outreach):

Subject: External Review Request: JMLR Paper on Hybrid LLM-Symbolic Discovery Dear Dr. [Last Name], I am writing to request your expertise as an external reviewer for my JMLR submission on hybrid approaches to analytical expression discovery. The paper demonstrates that symbolic methods achieve 0% extrapolation error while neural networks exhibit 1231% error (Mann-Whitney $U=0$, complete separation), with implications for reliable AI in scientific discovery. I believe your work on [specific paper] makes you an ideal reviewer. Key contributions: • Empirical demonstration of LLM reproductive behavior (100% classical physics vs 0% specialized domains) • Statistical proof of extrapolation superiority ($U=0$, $n=14$ vs $n=13$) • Hybrid architecture achieving 95.8% success across 131 tests Expected review time: 3-5 hours. I can provide the paper immediately if you're interested. Thank you for considering this request. Best regards, Ruperto Pedro Bonet Chaple

Step 6: Best Practices & Tips

Timing Considerations

- Send requests on Tuesday-Thursday (higher response rates than Monday/Friday)
- Avoid academic breaks (mid-December to mid-January, July-August)
- Allow 2-3 weeks for review once they accept
- Send gentle reminder after 1 week if no response to connection request

Professional Etiquette

- Always personalize messages (mention specific paper or project)
- Be transparent about time commitment (3-5 hours is realistic)
- Offer to provide 2-page summary for initial assessment
- Respect declines gracefully—ask if they can suggest alternative reviewers
- Follow up with thank you note after review is completed
- Acknowledge reviewers in the paper's acknowledgments section

Common Mistakes to Avoid

- Generic copy-paste messages (personalization matters)
- Sending paper before they agree to review (overwhelming)
- Asking for 1-week turnaround (unrealistic and disrespectful)
- Contacting only senior professors (they're often too busy)
- Not checking recent activity (inactive accounts won't respond)
- Forgetting to proofread your message for typos

Step 7: Track Your Outreach

Create a simple spreadsheet to track your outreach efforts:

Name	Expertise	Date Sent	Response	Status	Score
Dr. Jane Smith	Symbolic Regression	Jan 27	Pending	Contacted	8/10
Dr. John Doe	LLM Reasoning	Jan 28	Accepted	Reviewing	9/10

Recommended Outreach Volume:

- Contact 8-10 candidates to secure 2 reviewers (20-25% acceptance rate is typical)
- Diversify expertise: 1 symbolic regression expert + 1 LLM/ML theory expert
- Stagger requests over 3-5 days (don't spam 10 people on the same day)
- Have backup candidates ready in case of declines

Step 8: Specific Search Examples for Your Paper

Example 1: Find PySR Contributors

1. Search: "PySR" OR "SymbolicRegression.jl"
2. Filter: People → Higher Education → United States, Canada, UK
3. Check: Do they have GitHub linked? Look for PySR contributions
4. Evaluate: Recent commits, open issues engagement, documentation contributions
5. Contact: Mention specific feature or improvement they contributed

Example 2: Find Researchers Citing Your Key References

6. Go to Google Scholar, search for: Kambhampati 2024 'LLMs Can't Reason'
7. Click 'Cited by' to see who referenced this paper
8. Copy author names into LinkedIn search
9. Filter by recent activity and academic affiliation
10. These researchers are already interested in LLM limitations—perfect fit!

Example 3: Find Conference Program Committee Members

11. Visit NeurIPS 2024/2025 website → Program Committee list
12. Look for members in 'Machine Learning Theory' or 'Scientific ML' tracks
13. Cross-reference with LinkedIn using their full names
14. These reviewers are experienced and understand peer review expectations
15. Mention their PC service in your outreach message

Step 9: Materials to Provide Reviewers

Once a reviewer agrees, send them a package containing:

16. Full paper (jmlr_paper_with_fig.tex compiled to PDF)
17. 2-page executive summary highlighting: (a) Research question, (b) Core methodology, (c) Key result ($U=0$), (d) Main contributions
18. Assessment document (the one you just received) for context
19. Specific questions you want feedback on (3-5 focused questions)
20. Suggested timeline: 'Please provide feedback by [2-3 weeks from now]'
21. Your contact information and availability for clarifying questions

Sample Specific Questions to Ask:

- Is the Mann-Whitney $U=0$ result sufficiently emphasized, or does it get lost in the details?
- Does the extrapolation protocol (Definition 2, Section 5.2) seem rigorous and generalizable?
- Are the four contributions (Section 1.2) clearly distinct, or is there overlap?
- Does the failure mode analysis (Section 9.1) adequately address limitations?

- Is the paper length (48 pages) appropriate, or should certain sections move to appendix?

Recommended Timeline

Week	Activity	Details
Week 1	Search & Identify	Use 3 search queries, evaluate 15-20 candidates, score each on 10-point scale
Week 1-2	Initial Outreach	Send 8-10 personalized connection requests, staggered over 5-7 days
Week 2-3	Follow-up	Send review request to accepted connections, provide materials to those who agree
Week 3-6	Review Period	Reviewers assess paper (3-5 hours each), you remain available for questions
Week 6+	Incorporate Feedback	Revise paper based on reviewer comments, acknowledge reviewers, submit to JMLR

Final Tips for Success

- 1. Quality over Quantity:** Two excellent reviewers who provide thoughtful feedback are better than five mediocre reviewers who skim the paper.
- 2. Leverage Your Network:** Check if you have any second-degree connections to potential reviewers—mutual connections can make warm introductions.
- 3. Be Prepared for 'No':** Many researchers are overcommitted. Don't take rejections personally—it's about their bandwidth, not your paper.
- 4. Offer Value:** If appropriate, mention that you're happy to review their work in return (creates reciprocity).
- 5. Make it Easy:** Provide a well-organized PDF, clear questions, and suggested timeline. The less work they need to do to get started, the more likely they'll agree.

Good luck with your reviewer search!